

Checklist

Engineering Executive: Organizational Values

Measure for Yourself (Internal Leadership)

Measure to Plan

- ☐ Maintain a single view of Business, Product, and Engineering impact
- ☐ Track shipped projects by team
- ☐ Track the impact of each shipped project
- ☐ Use metrics to support prioritization (not just delivery mechanics)

Measure to Operate

- ☐ Track incident count (with review writeups)
- ☐ Track user-facing downtime
- ☐ Track API / website latency
- ☐ Track engineering cost normalized to a core business metric
- ☐ Track user ratings (e.g., app store ratings)
- ☐ Track onboarding conversion completion rate
- ☐ Review operational metrics regularly

Measure to Optimize

- ☐ Track delivery lead time
- ☐ Track deployment frequency
- ☐ Measure developer productivity (e.g., survey or framework like SPACE)
- ☐ Instrument feedback loops within engineering
- ☐ Use metrics to improve the system, not judge individuals

Measure to Inspire & Communicate

- ☐ Maintain a list of transformational technical investments
- ☐ Highlight generational improvements at company meetings
- ☐ Include at least one meaningful infrastructure improvement in annual planning
- ☐ Communicate the business impact of engineering work

Measure for Stakeholders

Measure for CEO / Board

- ☐ Define a clear goal aligned to the business strategy
- ☐ Share progress updates against that goal
- ☐ Reuse planning/operational metrics where possible
- ☐ Focus on business impact, not micro-optimization
- ☐ Avoid presenting optimization metrics as proof of impact

Measure for Finance

- ☐ Track actual vs budgeted headcount
- ☐ Track actual vs budgeted vendor costs
- ☐ Document capitalizable vs expensed engineering work
- ☐ Align on investment thesis and capacity allocation
- ☐ Document cost allocation methodology across initiatives

Measure for Strategic Peer Organizations (Product, Design, Sales)

- ☐ Align on shared business outcomes
- ☐ Use planning impact metrics to support collaboration
- ☐ Ensure engineering measurement supports cross-functional goals

Measure for Tactical Peer Organizations (Customer Success, Legal, etc.)

- ☐ Agree on concrete measurable outcomes
- ☐ Track shared operational metrics (e.g., resolution time, ticket acceptance)
- ☐ Establish regular review cadence
- ☐ Adjust metrics as cross-functional needs evolve

Sequence Your Measurement Work

- ☐ Only measure what you'll use in decision-making
- ☐ Measure some easy things to build trust
- ☐ Take on one new measurement initiative at a time
- ☐ Establish a baseline across major measurement categories
- ☐ Iterate and refine over time

Avoid Measurement Antipatterns

- ☐ Don't substitute metrics for trust-building
- ☐ Don't wait for perfect data before measuring
- ☐ Don't use optimization metrics to judge performance
- ☐ Don't measure individuals instead of teams
- ☐ Don't over-worry about potential misuse of data
- ☐ Don't decide measurement strategy in isolation

Build Confidence in Data

- ☐ Review data weekly
- ☐ Compare trends month-over-month or quarter-over-quarter
- ☐ Maintain explicit hypotheses about metric behavior
- ☐ Investigate when data contradicts expectations
- ☐ Review data collaboratively (not alone)
- ☐ Segment data to uncover hidden issues
- ☐ Compare objective metrics to subjective experience
- ☐ Document open questions and follow-ups

Ongoing Mindset

- ☐ Measure something (avoid measuring nothing)
- ☐ Iterate in small steps

- ☐ Focus on usefulness over perfection
- ☐ Treat measurement as an evolving process